

Fight rages in Lebanon even amid ceasefire

Hezbollah is defiant on ‘right to resist’ as Israel carries out fresh strikes

This article is by Mohamad El Chamaa, Victoria Crowe, Lior Soroka, Susannah George and Tara Copp

BEIRUT — Fighting between Israel and Hezbollah continued Friday even as President Donald Trump announced a three-week extension of the Israel-Lebanon ceasefire.

Hezbollah reacted with contempt to the extension, calling the truce “meaningless.” The Iran-backed militant group is still a powerful force in Lebanon, and concerns over the government’s ability to bring it under control have raised questions about the ceasefire’s long-term prospects.

Any Israeli operations in Lebanon give Hezbollah the right “to respond proportionately,” Ali Fayyad, a member of the Hezbollah faction in Lebanon’s parliament, said in a statement carried Friday by Hezbollah’s TV station Al Manar, adding that any deal that does not include an Israeli withdrawal from Lebanese territory affirms the Lebanese people’s “right to resist the occupation.”

“We are maintaining full freedom of action against any threat, including emerging ones,” Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in a statement addressing the peace process in Lebanon and accusing Hezbollah of trying to sabotage it. “We attacked yesterday and we attacked today.”

The 10-day ceasefire, which was due to expire on Sunday, has been only tenuously followed, with fewer but continued attacks by Israel and Hezbollah. Hezbollah has at-

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Netanyahu: Israeli leader says he hid prostate cancer from public. **A12**

Iran talks to resume in Pakistan sans Vance

Neither side will send its top negotiator to this weekend’s meeting

BY NATALIE ALLISON, JOHN HUDSON AND KAREN DEYOUNG

A U.S. delegation will resume talks with Iran in Islamabad, Pakistan, this weekend — but this time without Vice President JD Vance, the lead negotiator.

After Vance led a delegation there earlier this month that took part in more than 20 hours of negotiations on the ground, the White House this time said talks will be led by special envoy Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, President Donald Trump’s son-in-law who has taken part in past negotiations.

The decision not to send Vance, U.S. officials say, reflects the lower level of these talks after the last trip failed to result in a deal. The Iranians, likewise, will not be sending their top negotiator, Iran’s parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf. Wit-

SEE VANCE ON A12

A makeover on the Mall



RAHMAT GUL/AP

President Donald Trump is having the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool coated in a swimming pool surface hued in “American flag blue,” covering a granite surface that he said was “leaking like a sieve” and would take years to replace.

Musk’s fixation on race is turning off some fans

Billionaire posted on the topic 850 times in recent months, triple usual rate

BY FAIZ SIDDIQUI AND JEREMY B. MERRILL

Elon Musk, the world’s richest person, is on the cusp of a record-setting initial public offering that could soon make him a trillionaire. But in recent months he’s been increasingly vocal about something else: rallying White people to stand up for their race.

“Whites are a rapidly dying minority,” Musk wrote in January in a post on his social media site X that has garnered more than 17 million views and 150,000 likes. In a February post liked by more

than 365,000 accounts, Musk declared that “there has been unrelenting hate and poisonous propaganda in the West against anyone White, straight or male over the past decade or more,” adding, “No more guilt trips. ENOUGH.”

Musk’s X feed has for years served as a megaphone for his conservative views, especially since he emerged as one of the most prominent backers of Donald Trump in the 2024 presidential campaign. But a Washington Post analysis found that Musk has recently significantly increased his rate of online posts about race and his concerns about perceived threats to Whiteness or what he views as calls for a “genocide” against White people.

Over the past seven months, 6 percent of Musk’s posts on X, a total of about 850, have been

SEE MUSK ON A4

Super AI spurs scramble over its hacking prowess

Anthropic says Mythos can rapidly find, exploit cracks in digital security

BY IAN DUNCAN

When security researchers at Mozilla, the maker of the popular web browser Firefox, pointed a powerful new artificial intelligence model at their code, they had a feeling of “vertigo.”

Bobby Holley, the chief technology officer for the browser, said Anthropic’s Mythos system elevated AI from being merely a competent software engineer to “a world-class, elite security engineer.”

“It was just a ‘wow’ moment,” Holley said in an interview.

Almost a hundred engineers set aside other work to begin tackling a wave of security problems. The latest version of Firefox contains fixes for 271 flaws found with Mythos’s help. Any one of them would have been a red-alert moment just last year, Holley wrote in a blog post this week. The most serious vulnerabilities in older versions of the browser theoretically could be used to install programs or delete data, according to an advisory from the Center for Internet Security, although there is no evidence of them being put to use.

The findings were some of the first since Anthropic announced Mythos to the world this month, saying the new generative AI model could supercharge the abilities of hackers, making it too

SEE MYTHOS ON A5



SEAN RAYFORD/GETTY IMAGES

Blazes in Georgia destroy 120 homes

Smoke lingers in the air Friday in Atkinson, Georgia. An unusually large number of wildfires are burning this spring across the Southeast, the Associated Press reported, where scientists say the threat has been amplified by drought, gusty winds, climate change and trees toppled by Hurricane Helene two years ago.

Appeals court clears way to resume asylum cases

Trump administration could appeal ruling rejecting ‘invasion’ claim

BY MARIA SACCHETTI

A federal appeals court ruled Friday that President Donald Trump’s declaration of an “invasion” at the U.S.-Mexico border to restrict entry was illegal, effectively clearing the way to reopen the United States to migrants seeking asylum.

It was not clear when asylum processing would resume, and the Trump administration quickly indicated its intent to challenge the decision. White House spokeswoman Abigail Jackson said Trump had utilized his “lawful authority” to end the “egregious exploitation” of the U.S. asylum system.

The Justice Department “will seek further review of this badly

flawed decision and we are confident we will be vindicated,” she said in a statement.

The department did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Trump issued the proclamation, “Guaranteeing the States Protection Against Invasion,” on the first day of his second term, barring entry to asylum seekers for public safety, health and economic reasons “until I issue a finding that the invasion at the southern border has ceased.” Since then, Border Patrol apprehensions have fallen to the lowest levels in decades after spiking to record highs under the Biden administration.

Advocates for immigrants sued, however, arguing that the administration was violating federal law by rejecting people’s right to seek asylum because they fear persecution based on their political opinion, race or other reasons detailed in federal law. A lower-court judge had ruled in their

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